

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

Cuban Chicken Empanadas

with Lime Crema and Avocado

Empanar means "to bake in pastry" in Spanish. These handheld pies are traditionally filled with meat and vegetables and deep-fried. For tonight's repeat-hit Encore Recipe, the empanadas are stuffed with juicy roasted chicken and smoky-sweet spices, then baked to maximum crispiness. Dip in a lime, cilantro, and sour cream sauce for cool and zingy balance.

45–55 minutes 890 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 2 limes, divided
- 2 plum tomatoes
- ¼ ounce cilantro
- 3 cloves garlic, divided
- 1 red onion
- 3 boneless skinless chicken breasts
- 1 spice mix
  - 1 teaspoon ground cumin
  - 1 teaspoon sweet paprika
  - 1 teaspoon dried thyme
- 2 avocados
- 5 ounces shredded Monterey Jack cheese
- 9 empanada doughs
- 4 packets nonfat sour cream
- 5 ounces baby arugula

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
aluminum foil
baking sheet
blender or food processor (optional)

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Empanada dough becomes more pliable as it warms. Once tempered, you can gently stretch it over the filling to seal. If you end up with any extra filling, serve it with the empanadas at the end.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse all produce. Halve **limes**. Quarter **tomatoes**. Roughly chop **cilantro** leaves, discarding stems. Mince **garlic**. Peel **onion**, halve, and thinly slice. Line a baking sheet with foil for the next step.



2. Roast chicken and vegetables

Pat **chicken** dry with paper towel and place on 1 half of prepared baking sheet. Rub all over with **spice mix**, **2 teaspoons olive oil**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. On other half of sheet, toss **tomatoes** and **onion** with **half of garlic**, **½ tablespoon olive oil**, and **⅛ teaspoon salt**. Arrange in a single layer. Roast until chicken is cooked through and no longer pink and vegetables are tender, 13–15 minutes.



3. Make dressing and prepare avocado

While chicken and vegetables roast, in a large bowl, whisk together **juice of 1 lime**, **2 tablespoons olive oil**, **⅛ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Halve **avocados** and discard pits; carefully scoop out flesh, discarding skins, then cut into small dice. Add **diced avocados** to bowl with dressing, then set aside.



4. Assemble empanadas

Once roasted, roughly chop **chicken** and **vegetables** and place in a medium bowl. Add **Monterey Jack** to bowl and stir to combine. Discard foil from baking sheet and line with a new piece of foil. Add **empanada doughs** in a single layer. Working 1 at a time, spoon about **¼ cup filling** onto 1 half of each. Carefully fold dough over filling (see recipe tip). Using the tines of a fork, press and seal edges tightly.



5. Bake empanadas and make crema

Cut a small slit on top of **empanadas** so steam can escape. Bake until puffed and light golden, about 15 minutes. Meanwhile, in a blender or food processor, combine **sour cream**, **cilantro**, **juice of remaining lime**, **remaining garlic**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired, and blend until smooth. Alternatively, whisk together all crema ingredients in a small bowl.



6. Plate empanadas

Pat **arugula** dry with paper towel, add to bowl with dressing and avocados, and toss to coat. Serve **Cuban chicken empanadas** with **salad** and **lime crema** for dipping. Enjoy!

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